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EFFICIENTLY ROUTING EXCESS AIR FLOW

Abstract

Architectures and techniques are presented that can more efficiently route excess air flow by intelligently selecting the zones to which the excess air flow is to be routed. Excess air flow results from an HVAC device providing (e.g., at a minimum setting) a volume of air that is greater than what is demanded by a zone that triggers activation of the HVAC device. As one example, excess air flow can be routed to a zone or zones that are determined to be most likely to trigger a subsequent activation condition that would cause the HVAC device to be activated again at a future time.

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Background/Summary

RELATED APPLICATION [0001] This application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/561,247, filed Sep. 5, 2019, the specification of which is incorporated herein by reference in its entirety.

TECHNICAL FIELD

[0002] The present disclosure is directed to systems, apparatuses, and methods for determining which zone(s) are to receive excess air flow, and more particularly to determining the zones in a manner that is efficient.

BACKGROUND

[0003] Modern heating, ventilation, and air conditioning (HVAC) systems can provide conditioned air to a large group of individually controllable zones. Typically, the HVAC system is designed to be capable to meet the needs of the entire group. Hence, it is a common situation that one of the HVAC devices, such as an air handler or the like, when activated at a minimum setting, will provide more tempered air than is necessary to serve any one zone. It is also a common situation for a single zone from among the group to meet conditions such as a set point criterion that will cause the HVAC device to activate while the remainder of the zones do not meet any such conditions, and therefore do not need and/or do not trigger the HVAC device. As a result, the HVAC device is activated at a minimum setting (e.g., 750 cubic feet per minute (CFM)), that still provides more airflow than is needed to meet the demands of the signaling zone (e.g., 100 CFM). This remainder (e.g., $750\text{ CFM} - 100\text{ CFM} = 650\text{ CFM}$), is referred to herein as excess air flow.

SUMMARY

[0004] The following presents a summary to provide a basic understanding of one or more embodiments of the disclosure. This summary is not intended to identify key or critical elements or delineate any scope of the particular embodiments or any scope of the claims. Its sole purpose is to present concepts in a simplified form as a prelude to the more detailed description that is presented later.

[0005] According to an embodiment of the present disclosure, a device can comprise a processor and a memory that stores executable instructions that, when executed by the processor, facilitate performance of operations. The computer executable instructions can comprise determining that a heating, ventilation, and air conditioning (HVAC) device, configured to provide a defined volume of air, is indicated to activate in response to an activation condition being satisfied with respect to a first zone of a group of zones. The computer executable instructions can comprise determining an excess volume of air representative of the defined volume of air provided by the HVAC device less a first zone volume that is delivered to the first zone. The computer executable instructions can comprise, performing an excess routing procedure that identifies a second zone of the group of zones to which to route at least a portion of the excess volume.

[0006] According to an embodiment of this disclosure, the performing the excess routing procedure can comprise determining that the second zone, from among the group of zones, is most likely to trigger a subsequent activation condition for the HVAC device.

[0007] According to an embodiment of this disclosure, the performing the excess routing procedure can comprise determining respective differences between respective measured quantities of respective zones of the group and corresponding unoccupied set points of the respective zones. Thereafter, the second zone can be identified in response to determining that the second zone has a smallest difference from among the respective differences.

[0008] According to an embodiment of this disclosure, the performing the excess routing procedure can comprise determining respective differences between respective measured quantities of respective zones of the group and corresponding occupied set points of the respective zones.

Thereafter, the second zone can be identified in response to determining that the second zone has a largest difference from among the respective differences.

[0009] According to an embodiment of this disclosure, the performing the excess routing procedure can comprise determining respective rates of change of respective measured quantities of respective zones of the group. Thereafter, the second zone can be identified based on respective states of the respective zones and the respective rates of change.

[0010] According to an embodiment of this disclosure, the performing the excess routing procedure can comprise identifying the second zone based on a determination that the second zone is most likely, from among the group of zones, to be a next zone to be occupied.

[0011] In some embodiments, elements described in connection with the systems above can be embodied in different forms such as a computer-implemented method, a computer-readable medium, or another form.

Description

DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0012] FIG. 1 illustrates a block diagram of an example non-limiting system that can provide more efficient routing of excess flow in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosed subject matter;

[0013] FIG. 2A illustrates a block diagram depicting non-limiting examples of one or more activation condition(s) in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosed subject matter;

[0014] FIG. 2B illustrates a block diagram depicting non-limiting examples of a determination of a zone most likely to trigger a subsequent activation condition in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosed subject matter;

[0015] FIG. 3 illustrates a block diagram of an example non-limiting system that illustrates in more detail an example determinations in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosed subject matter;

[0016] FIG. 4 illustrates a block diagram depicting non-limiting examples of a data set or other information that can be used in connection with various determinations detailed herein in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosed subject matter

[0017] FIG. 5 illustrates a block diagram of system depicting non-limiting examples of controlling dampers to effectuate the routing of excess volume in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosed subject matter;

[0018] FIGS. 6A-C illustrate block diagrams of example architectural implementations that can be employed in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosed subject matter;

[0019] FIG. 7 illustrates a flow diagram of an example, non-limiting computer-implemented method that can efficiently route excess airflow in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosed subject matter;

[0020] FIG. 8 illustrates a flow diagram of an example, non-limiting computer-implemented method providing additional aspects or elements in connection with efficiently routing excess airflow in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosed subject matter; and

[0021] FIG. 9 illustrates a block diagram of an example, non-limiting operating environment in which one or more embodiments described herein can be facilitated.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

Overview

[0022] While this specification discusses and refers to an excess air flow, it is understood that the disclosed techniques can be applicable to any fluid flow in addition to air flow. As noted previously, a common situation arises where an HVAC device (e.g., a fan, blower, air handler, etc.)

is activated in response to activation conditions being met by one or more zones served by the HVAC device. For example, if a given state of a zone satisfies an activation condition (e.g., a set point), such can trigger a signal to activate the HVAC device. Because the HVAC device can be sized to serve many zones, but only one zone or a few zones may be in a state to meet activation conditions, activating the HVAC device can be inefficient.

[0023] For instance, consider the case where the HVAC device provides, at a minimum setting, 750 CFM, whereas the zone that triggered the activation is supplied only 100 CFM. It is appreciated that if one or more zones collectively call for more than is provided by the minimum setting, say 800 CFM, the HVAC device might be activated at an intermediate setting that may provide, for example, 1000 CFM, causing an excess of 200 CFM. In either case, it is appreciated that excess air flow will exist, and the disclosed techniques are equally applicable to either scenario.

[0024] Returning to the first example, where the excess air flow is 650 CFM (e.g., 750 CFM provided by HVAC device less 100 CFM allocated to the activating zone), it can be especially inefficient or wasteful if that excess air flow is not put to work in some way in the system. Known approaches to allocating and/or routing the excess air flow are not satisfactory. For example, other systems that at least attempt to make use of the excess air flow tend take one of the two following approaches: (1) distribute the excess air flow among all zones or some predetermined subset of the zones; or (2) distribute the excess air flow to a predetermined specific class of zones. An example is common areas, such as bathrooms, conference rooms, or the like. Both approaches tend to be wasteful.

[0025] The disclosed subject matter introduces better intelligence in determining where to route excess air flow, which can be more efficient in terms of energy consumption. Furthermore, the disclosed techniques can reduce the duty cycle of HVAC equipment, which can extend the life of certain HVAC equipment. As one illustrative example, the disclosed subject matter can intelligently determine to route excess air flow to zones that are determined to be more likely to trigger a subsequent activation condition. Such can extend the time between the subsequent activation condition being triggered and/or reduce the load when the subsequent activation condition is triggered.

Example Systems

[0026] The disclosed subject matter is now described with reference to the drawings, wherein like reference numerals are used to refer to like elements throughout. In the following description, for purposes of explanation, numerous specific details are set forth in order to provide a thorough understanding of the disclosed subject matter. It may be evident, however, that the disclosed subject matter may be practiced without these specific details. In other instances, well-known structures and devices are shown in block diagram form in order to facilitate describing the disclosed subject matter.

[0027] Referring now to the drawings, with initial reference to FIG. 1, a block diagram of an example non-limiting system **100** is depicted that can provide more efficient routing of excess flow in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosed subject matter. In some embodiments, system **100** can comprise device **101** that can be employed to make various determinations detailed herein. Device **100** can comprise a processor and a memory that stores executable instructions that, when executed by the processor, facilitate performance of operations. Examples of said processor and memory, as well as other suitable computer or computing-based elements, can be found with reference to FIG. 9, and can be used in connection with implementing one or more of the devices or components shown and described in connection with FIG. 1 or other figures disclosed herein. It should be understood that in the discussion of the present embodiment and of embodiments to follow, repetitive description of like elements employed in the various embodiments described herein is omitted for sake of brevity.

[0028] System **100** can further comprise a heating, ventilation, and air conditioning (HVAC) device **102**, which can be for example, a fan, blower, air handler, and so forth. HVAC device **102** can be

configured to provide a defined volume of air **104** (also referred to herein as defined volume **104** and airflow **104**) upon activation. Defined volume **104** can be representative of a volume of air that is provided by HVAC device **102** based on a setting, typically, but not necessarily, a minimum setting for the HVAC device **102**.

[0029] Defined volume **104** can be provided to some portion of group of zones **106**, illustrated here as first zone **106.sub.1** to Nth zone **106.sub.N**, where N can be any whole number, but will typically be greater than three. In some embodiments, individual members of group of zones **106** can be individually controlled. For example, distinct set points can be input for any member of the group of zones **106**. When a state of one of the group of zones **106** (e.g., first zone **106.sub.1**) satisfies a set point (or other activation condition **110**), an appropriate device can transmit activation request **108** to HVAC device **102**, indicating that HVAC device **102** is to be activated.

[0030] Device **101** can determine that HVAC device **102** is indicated to be activated (e.g., receiving and potentially forwarding activation request **108**). In response, device **101** can perform determination **112**. Determination **112** can comprise determining an excess volume of air. The excess volume of air can represent defined volume **104** (e.g., provided by HVAC device **102** at a minimum or other setting) less a first zone volume that is to be delivered to the zone triggering activation request **108** (e.g., first zone **106.sub.1**).

[0031] Once the excess volume is determined, device **101** can perform excess routing procedure **114**. Excess routing procedure **114** can identify a second zone **106.sub.2** of the group of zones **106** to which to route at least a portion of the excess volume. Excess routing procedure can include determination **116**. Determination **116** can comprise determining that second zone **106.sub.2**, from among group of zones **106**, is most likely to trigger a subsequent activation condition for HVAC device **102**.

[0032] In some embodiments, if multiple zones are determined to be equally likely to trigger the subsequent activation condition, second zone **106.sub.2** can be selected due to the amount of CFM required. For example, of the two candidates, the zone that has a CFM requirement that is closest to using up the excess routing procedure without going under can be selected. In some embodiments, excess routing procedure **114** can be performed iteratively to identify additional zone(s) of group of zones **106** to which to route the excess volume until no excess volume remains.

[0033] While still referring to FIG. 1, but turning as well to FIG. 2A, a block diagram **200A** is presented depicting non-limiting examples of activation condition(s) **110** in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosed subject matter. As noted, any zone of the group of zones **106** can potentially trigger HVAC device **102**. In some embodiments, activation condition **110** can be the result of manual input or signal, while in other embodiments, activation condition **110** can be satisfied in response to a determination that a first measured quantity meets a first value designated by a set point. Examples **202-206** represent examples of an occupancy set point, a temperature set point, a humidity set point, etc. being met or satisfied.

[0034] It is appreciated that a given zone **106** can have multiple set points, for example, an occupied set point and an unoccupied set point. The unoccupied set point is typically not as comfortable to occupants as the occupied set point, but rather is selected to reduce the demands on the HVAC system. For instance, during the day when an associated building is occupied, group of zones **106** can operate according to comfort settings associated with occupied set points. At night, when few or no people are in the building, group of zones **106** can operate according to the unoccupied set points in which comfort settings and other thresholds can be greatly relaxed. If however, someone enters one of the zones **106**, such can satisfy activation condition **110**, either by satisfying occupancy set point **202** or satisfying temperature set point **204**, humidity set point **206** or another suitable set point as the associated set point reverts from the unoccupied value to the occupied value.

[0035] Regardless, once activation condition **110** is satisfied, a signal (e.g., activation request **108**) can be sent to trigger activation of HVAC device **102** and device **101** can perform excess routing

procedure **114** to determine where to route the excess flow. As mentioned, excess routing procedure **114** can comprise determination **116** that identifies a zone **106** that is most likely to trigger a subsequent activation condition

[0036] FIG. 2B illustrates a block diagram **200B** depicting non-limiting examples of determination **116** in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosed subject matter. In some embodiments, determination **116** can rely on knowledge of zone **106** state data and other information, which is described in more detail with reference to FIGS. 3 and 4. For example, determination **116** can depend on whether zones **106** are occupied or unoccupied as well as the respective set points for both and current physical conditions of the group of zones **106**. The inventors have observed that in the case of an unoccupied building it can be more efficient to reduce the number of times HVAC device **102** cycles on.

[0037] Therefore, supposing first zone **106.sub.1** triggers activation condition **110** because a temperature of first zone **106.sub.1** meets an unoccupied set point, device **101** can examine how close other zones **106** are to meeting their own respective unoccupied set points. The zone **106**, e.g., second zone **106.sub.2**, with the smallest difference from an associated unoccupied set point can be inferred to be the one most likely to trigger a subsequent activation condition, which is illustrated at reference numeral **212**. Hence, second zone **106.sub.2** that is nearest to the conditions that will trigger a subsequent activation condition can be selected to receive all or a portion of the excess air flow. In other words, device **101** can determine respective differences between respective measured quantities (e.g., occupancy, temperature, humidity, etc.) of respective zones **106** and corresponding unoccupied set points of the respective zones **106**. Next, device **101** can identify second zone **106.sub.2** in response to determining that second zone **106.sub.2** has the smallest difference from among the respective differences. As a result, the physical state of second zone **106.sub.2** will move away from the unoccupied set point, and thus be less likely to trigger a subsequent activation condition.

[0038] As another example illustrated by reference numeral **214**, determination **116** can identify second zone **106.sub.2** as most likely to trigger a subsequent activation condition based on having a largest difference from an occupied set point. It is understood that the physical conditions of the group of zones **106** will typically be in a range between the occupied set point (that is no longer enforced when unoccupied) and the unoccupied set point (that, if met, will trigger activation of HVAC device **102**). Depending on settings, some zones **106** can be much farther away from the occupied set point than others, without nearing the unoccupied set point that would trigger HVAC device **102** activation. The inventors have observed that in the case of a very large difference from an occupied set point, when the second zone **106.sub.2** does become occupied, it can take a long time to correct the temperature or other physical conditions of second zone **106.sub.2**, which can also be inefficient or less desirable. In other words, device **101** can determine respective differences between respective measured quantities (e.g., occupancy, temperature, humidity, etc.) of respective zones **106** and corresponding occupied set points of the respective zones **106**. Next, device **101** can identify second zone **106.sub.2** in response to determining that second zone **106.sub.2** has the largest difference from among the respective differences. As a result, the physical state of second zone **106.sub.2** can be brought to the occupied set point thresholds more quickly.

[0039] In another example illustrated by reference numeral **216**, determination **116** can identify second zone **106.sub.2** as most likely to trigger a subsequent activation condition based on a rate of change of a physical quantity. In other words, device **101** can determine respective rates of change of respective measured quantities of respective zones **106**. Next, device **101** can identify second zone **106.sub.2** in response to determining that second zone **106.sub.2** has the highest rate of change either away from an occupied set point or toward an unoccupied set point. It is understood that having a greater rate of change can be another indicator in determining zones **106** that are most likely to trigger a subsequent activation condition.

[0040] Reference numeral **218** illustrates yet another mechanism for determination **116**. For

example, based on a history, a schedule, or other data, second zone **106.sub.2** can be identified as most likely to trigger a subsequent activation condition based on a determination that second zone **106.sub.2** will be occupied next. As explained, when a zone **106** becomes occupied, set points can revert from the unoccupied setting to the occupied setting, which will typically trigger activation request **108**. By providing second zone **106.sub.2** with the excess flow in advance, the effects of switching to occupied mode can be reduced sharply.

[0041] With reference now to FIG. **3**, a block diagram of an example non-limiting system **300** is depicted. System **300** illustrates in more detail an example of determination **116** in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosed subject matter. In this example, determination **116** of a zone **106** most likely to trigger a subsequent activation condition is made according to smallest difference from unoccupied set point **212** discussed in connection with FIG. **2B**.

[0042] System **300** can include device **101** that can perform determination **116** as well as other determinations detailed herein, and HVAC device **102** that, when activated, can provide the defined volume **104** of air, illustrated here as airflow **104**, which, in this example is 750 CFM. HVAC device **102** serves ten different zones, each of which can be individually controlled and thus maintain individual set points.

[0043] Device **101** can include or be communicatively coupled to data store **302** that can store various data sets **304** that can be employed to determine excess volume **112** or perform excess routing procedure **114**. For example, data set **304** can include information about various settings for HVAC device and the defined volume **104**. Data set **304** can further include various zone state data **306** indicative of a states (e.g., physical conditions) of the various zones, corresponding set point, both occupied and unoccupied, and so forth. The present example is directed to a non-limiting cooling example.

[0044] As depicted, zone 1 has a current temperature of 80° that is above the unoccupied cooling set point of 78°, which causes activation request **108**. No other zones meet conditions that would trigger HVAC device **102** activation. Device **101** can determine that HVAC device **102** is being activated and further determine the excess volume. In this case, the defined volume **104** is 750 CFM (e.g., a minimum setting for HVAC device **102**) while the airflow demand of zone 1 is 100 CFM. Thus, the excess volume is $750 - 100 = 650$ CFM, which device **101** can intelligently allocate based on performing the excess routing procedure **114**.

[0045] Excess routing procedure **114**, in this example, can identify a current deviation or difference from the corresponding unoccupied set point. In order of smallest to largest zone 4 is only 1° away from the unoccupied set point and therefore can be considered to be most likely to trigger a subsequent activation condition that will activate HVAC device **102**. Next is zone 3, which is 2° away from the respective unoccupied set point, followed by zone 7 (3° away), zones 1 and 10 (4° away), zone 6 (5° away) zones 5 and 9 (6° away), and zone 8 (8° away).

[0046] Once sorted on closest to set point, the zones can be chosen to meet defined volume **104**. In this case, the excess routing procedure **114** selects zones 4, 3, 7, and 2. Including the 100 CFM demanded by zone 1, which triggered HVAC device **102**, the total airflow demand of the selected zones is $100 + 300 + 150 + 125 + 200 = 875$ CFM. It is noted that both zone 2 and zone 10 are 4° from their respective set points, however, the excess routing procedure **114** selected zone 2 instead of zone 10 because zone 2 provides the closest airflow match to the defined volume **104** provided by HVAC device **102** at the current setting. In other words, when multiple zones will meet the smallest different criteria, excess routing procedure **114** can first select the zones closest to their unoccupied set point. If multiple spaces have the same deviation from that set point (e.g., zones 2 and 10) the application can select the zone resulting in the closest total to defined volume **104** without going under. Had zone 10 been selected instead of zone 2, the total airflow demand would be $100 + 300 + 150 + 125 + 320 = 995$ CFM, which is farther away from the defined volume of 750 CFM and thus less preferred in this embodiment. It is appreciated that, in other embodiments, the 995 CFM might be preferred and in those cases, zone 10 can be selected instead of zone 2.

[0047] Turning now to FIG. 4, a block diagram **400** is presented depicting non-limiting examples of data set **304** or other information that can be used in connection with determination **116** or other determinations detailed herein in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosed subject matter. For example, as noted, data set **304** can include zone state data **306** indicative of current, historical, or predicted states of group of zones **106**. As another example, data set **304** can include schedule data **402** that can be indicative of expected changes to states of group of zones **106** or to a state of HVAC device **102** or another HVAC device.

[0048] In some embodiments, data set **304** can include historical data **404** that can be indicative of past changes to states of group of zones **106** or changes to a state of HVAC device **102** or another HVAC device. In some embodiments, data set **304** can include weather data **406** that can be indicative of past or expected changes to states of group of zones **106** or changes to a state of HVAC device **102** or another HVAC device. In some embodiments, data set **304** can include location data **408** that can be indicative of a physical location of group of zones **106**, such as, for example, whether a zone is interior to the building or has exterior exposure, a salient direction of the exterior exposure (e.g., facing north, east, south, west, etc.) and so forth. In some embodiments, data set **304** can include thermal mass data **410** that can be indicative of a time or an energy metric to change the states of group of zones **106**.

[0049] Referring now to FIG. 5, a block diagram of system **500** is presented depicting non-limiting examples of controlling dampers to effectuate the routing of excess volume in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosed subject matter. Device **101** can include or be coupled to damper controller device **503** that can control, e.g., via an actuator or motor, various dampers of a variable air volume (VAV) device **502**, including inlet damper **504** and one or more outlet dampers **506**, **510**, and **514**. In this example, it is again assumed that zone 1 triggers activation of HVAC device **102**, causing defined volume **104** to be provided. In response, inlet damper **504** and outlet damper **506** can be opened, at least partially, and the airflow demand of zone 1 provided, illustrated here as first zone volume **508**. Device **101** can perform excess routing procedure **114** to determine that the excess volume should be routed to zone 2 and possible other zones (not shown). Hence, outlet damper **510** can be at least partially opened to allow second zone volume **512** to reach zone 2. Zone not selected by excess routing procedure **114**, such as zone N, can have associated dampers (e.g., outlet damper **514**) closed.

[0050] Turning now to FIGS. 6A-6C, various block diagrams **600A-600C** of example architectural implementations are illustrated in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosed subject matter.

[0051] For example, block diagram **600A** depicts an example architectural design in which device **101** is situated in a remote system such as a cloud system **602**. Device **101** can be representative of a device that performs excess volume determination **112**, excess routing procedure **114** as illustrated in connection with FIG. 1. In other words, in some embodiments, device **101** can be remote from HVAC device **102** and/or group of zones **106**.

[0052] Block diagram **600B** depicts an example architectural design in which data store **302** is in a remote system such as a cloud system **602**. In this embodiment, device **101** can be situated at a user site and communicate with the cloud to make various determinations,. In other embodiments, both device **101** and data store **302** can be situated in cloud system **602** and communicate with HVAC device **102** and/or group of zones **106** and associated devices.

[0053] Block diagram **600C** depicts an example architectural design in which one or both user device **101** and data store **302** are components of HVAC device **102**, which can be situated at the user site.

Example Methods

[0054] FIGS. 7 and 8 illustrate various methodologies in accordance with the disclosed subject matter. While, for purposes of simplicity of explanation, the methodologies are shown and described as a series of acts, it is to be understood and appreciated that the disclosed subject matter

is not limited by the order of acts, as some acts can occur in different orders and/or concurrently with other acts from that shown and described herein. For example, those skilled in the art will understand and appreciate that a methodology could alternatively be represented as a series of interrelated states or events, such as in a state diagram. Moreover, not all illustrated acts can be required to implement a methodology in accordance with the disclosed subject matter. Additionally, it should be further appreciated that the methodologies disclosed hereinafter and throughout this specification are capable of being stored on an article of manufacture to facilitate transporting and transferring such methodologies to computers.

[0055] FIG. 7 illustrates a flow diagram **700** of an example, non-limiting computer-implemented method that can efficiently route excess airflow in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosed subject matter. For example, at reference numeral **702**, a device (e.g., device **101**) comprising a processor can determine that a heating, ventilation, and air conditioning (HVAC) device, configured to provide a defined volume of air, is activated in response to an activation condition being satisfied with respect to a first zone of a group of zones.

[0056] At reference numeral **704**, the device can determine an excess volume of air representative of the defined volume of air provided by the HVAC device less a first zone volume that is delivered to the first zone.

[0057] At reference numeral **706**, the device can perform an excess routing procedure that identifies a second zone of the group of zones to which to route at least a portion of the excess volume. At reference numeral **708**, as part of the excess routing procedure, the device can determine that the second zone, from among the group of zones, is most likely to trigger a subsequent activation condition for the HVAC device. Method **700** can proceed to insert A, which is further detailed in connection with FIG. 8, or terminate.

[0058] Turning now to FIG. 8, illustrated is a flow diagram **800** of an example, non-limiting computer-implemented method that can provide additional aspects or elements in connection with efficiently routing excess airflow in accordance with one or more embodiments of the disclosed subject matter. For example, FIG. 8 depicts various embodiments of the excess routing procedure and/or various distinct ways to select the zone or zones to which to route the excess volume.

[0059] At reference numeral **802**, the device can determine respective differences between respective measured quantities of respective zones of the group and corresponding unoccupied set points of the respective zones. At reference numeral **804**, the device can identify the second zone in response to determining that the second zone has a smallest difference from among the respective differences.

[0060] Additionally or alternatively, at reference numeral **806**, the device can determine respective differences between respective measured quantities of respective zones of the group and corresponding occupied (as opposed to unoccupied) set points of the respective zones. At reference numeral **808**, the device can identify the second zone in response to determining that the second zone has a largest difference from among the respective differences.

[0061] Additionally or alternatively, at reference numeral **810**, the device can determine respective rates of change of respective measured quantities of respective zones of the group. At reference numeral **812**, the device can identify the second zone based on respective states of the respective zones and the respective rates of change. For instance, based on both how near to the set point corresponding physical conditions or other states are and how high the rate of change is.

[0062] Additionally or alternatively, at reference numeral **814**, the device can determine that the second zone is most likely to trigger the subsequent activation condition based on a determination, by the device, that the second zone is most likely, from among the group of zones, to be a next zone to be occupied.

Example Operating Environments

[0063] In order to provide additional context for various embodiments described herein, FIG. 9 and the following discussion are intended to provide a brief, general description of a suitable computing

environment **900** in which the various embodiments of the embodiment described herein can be implemented. While the embodiments have been described above in the general context of computer-executable instructions that can run on one or more computers, those skilled in the art will recognize that the embodiments can be also implemented in combination with other program modules and/or as a combination of hardware and software.

[0064] Generally, program modules include routines, programs, components, data structures, etc., that perform particular tasks or implement particular abstract data types. Moreover, those skilled in the art will appreciate that the inventive methods can be practiced with other computer system configurations, including single-processor or multiprocessor computer systems, minicomputers, mainframe computers, Internet of Things (IoT) devices, distributed computing systems, as well as personal computers, hand-held computing devices, microprocessor-based or programmable consumer electronics, and the like, each of which can be operatively coupled to one or more associated devices.

[0065] The illustrated embodiments of the embodiments herein can be also practiced in distributed computing environments where certain tasks are performed by remote processing devices that are linked through a communications network. In a distributed computing environment, program modules can be located in both local and remote memory storage devices.

[0066] Computing devices typically include a variety of media, which can include computer-readable storage media, machine-readable storage media, and/or communications media, which two terms are used herein differently from one another as follows. Computer-readable storage media or machine-readable storage media can be any available storage media that can be accessed by the computer and includes both volatile and nonvolatile media, removable and non-removable media. By way of example, and not limitation, computer-readable storage media or machine-readable storage media can be implemented in connection with any method or technology for storage of information such as computer-readable or machine-readable instructions, program modules, structured data or unstructured data.

[0067] Computer-readable storage media can include, but are not limited to, random access memory (RAM), read only memory (ROM), electrically erasable programmable read only memory (EEPROM), flash memory or other memory technology, compact disk read only memory (CD-ROM), digital versatile disk (DVD), Blu-ray disc (BD) or other optical disk storage, magnetic cassettes, magnetic tape, magnetic disk storage or other magnetic storage devices, solid state drives or other solid state storage devices, or other tangible and/or non-transitory media which can be used to store desired information. In this regard, the terms “tangible” or “non-transitory” herein as applied to storage, memory or computer-readable media, are to be understood to exclude only propagating transitory signals per se as modifiers and do not relinquish rights to all standard storage, memory or computer-readable media that are not only propagating transitory signals per se.

[0068] Computer-readable storage media can be accessed by one or more local or remote computing devices, e.g., via access requests, queries or other data retrieval protocols, for a variety of operations with respect to the information stored by the medium.

[0069] Communications media typically embody computer-readable instructions, data structures, program modules or other structured or unstructured data in a data signal such as a modulated data signal, e.g., a carrier wave or other transport mechanism, and includes any information delivery or transport media. The term “modulated data signal” or signals refers to a signal that has one or more of its characteristics set or changed in such a manner as to encode information in one or more signals. By way of example, and not limitation, communication media include wired media, such as a wired network or direct-wired connection, and wireless media such as acoustic, RF, infrared and other wireless media.

[0070] With reference again to FIG. **9**, the example environment **900** for implementing various embodiments of the aspects described herein includes a computer **902**, the computer **902** including

a processing unit **904**, a system memory **906** and a system bus **908**. The system bus **908** couples system components including, but not limited to, the system memory **906** to the processing unit **904**. The processing unit **904** can be any of various commercially available processors. Dual microprocessors and other multi-processor architectures can also be employed as the processing unit **904**.

[0071] The system bus **908** can be any of several types of bus structure that can further interconnect to a memory bus (with or without a memory controller), a peripheral bus, and a local bus using any of a variety of commercially available bus architectures. The system memory **906** includes ROM **910** and RAM **912**. A basic input/output system (BIOS) can be stored in a non-volatile memory such as ROM, erasable programmable read only memory (EPROM), EEPROM, which BIOS contains the basic routines that help to transfer information between elements within the computer **902**, such as during startup. The RAM **912** can also include a high-speed RAM such as static RAM for caching data.

[0072] The computer **902** further includes an internal hard disk drive (HDD) **914** (e.g., EIDE, SATA), one or more external storage devices **916** (e.g., a magnetic floppy disk drive (FDD) **916**, a memory stick or flash drive reader, a memory card reader, etc.) and an optical disk drive **920** (e.g., which can read or write from a CD-ROM disc, a DVD, a BD, etc.). While the internal HDD **914** is illustrated as located within the computer **902**, the internal HDD **914** can also be configured for external use in a suitable chassis (not shown). Additionally, while not shown in environment **900**, a solid state drive (SSD) could be used in addition to, or in place of, an HDD **914**. The HDD **914**, external storage device(s) **916** and optical disk drive **920** can be connected to the system bus **908** by an HDD interface **924**, an external storage interface **926** and an optical drive interface **928**, respectively. The interface **924** for external drive implementations can include at least one or both of Universal Serial Bus (USB) and Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers (IEEE) 994 interface technologies. Other external drive connection technologies are within contemplation of the embodiments described herein.

[0073] The drives and their associated computer-readable storage media provide nonvolatile storage of data, data structures, computer-executable instructions, and so forth. For the computer **902**, the drives and storage media accommodate the storage of any data in a suitable digital format. Although the description of computer-readable storage media above refers to respective types of storage devices, it should be appreciated by those skilled in the art that other types of storage media which are readable by a computer, whether presently existing or developed in the future, could also be used in the example operating environment, and further, that any such storage media can contain computer-executable instructions for performing the methods described herein.

[0074] A number of program modules can be stored in the drives and RAM **912**, including an operating system **930**, one or more application programs **932**, other program modules **934** and program data **936**. All or portions of the operating system, applications, modules, and/or data can also be cached in the RAM **912**. The systems and methods described herein can be implemented utilizing various commercially available operating systems or combinations of operating systems.

[0075] Computer **902** can optionally comprise emulation technologies. For example, a hypervisor (not shown) or other intermediary can emulate a hardware environment for operating system **930**, and the emulated hardware can optionally be different from the hardware illustrated in FIG. 9. In such an embodiment, operating system **930** can comprise one virtual machine (VM) of multiple VMs hosted at computer **902**. Furthermore, operating system **930** can provide runtime environments, such as the Java runtime environment or the .NET framework, for applications **932**. Runtime environments are consistent execution environments that allow applications **932** to run on any operating system that includes the runtime environment. Similarly, operating system **930** can support containers, and applications **932** can be in the form of containers, which are lightweight, standalone, executable packages of software that include, e.g., code, runtime, system tools, system libraries and settings for an application.

[0076] Further, computer **902** can be enabled with a security module, such as a trusted processing module (TPM). For instance with a TPM, boot components hash next in time boot components, and wait for a match of results to secured values, before loading a next boot component. This process can take place at any layer in the code execution stack of computer **902**, e.g., applied at the application execution level or at the operating system (OS) kernel level, thereby enabling security at any level of code execution.

[0077] A user can enter commands and information into the computer **902** through one or more wired/wireless input devices, e.g., a keyboard **938**, a touch screen **940**, and a pointing device, such as a mouse **942**. Other input devices (not shown) can include a microphone, an infrared (IR) remote control, a radio frequency (RF) remote control, or other remote control, a joystick, a virtual reality controller and/or virtual reality headset, a game pad, a stylus pen, an image input device, e.g., camera(s), a gesture sensor input device, a vision movement sensor input device, an emotion or facial detection device, a biometric input device, e.g., fingerprint or iris scanner, or the like. These and other input devices are often connected to the processing unit **904** through an input device interface **944** that can be coupled to the system bus **908**, but can be connected by other interfaces, such as a parallel port, an IEEE 1394 serial port, a game port, a USB port, an IR interface, a BLUETOOTH® interface, etc.

[0078] A monitor **946** or other type of display device can be also connected to the system bus **908** via an interface, such as a video adapter **948**. In addition to the monitor **946**, a computer typically includes other peripheral output devices (not shown), such as speakers, printers, etc.

[0079] The computer **902** can operate in a networked environment using logical connections via wired and/or wireless communications to one or more remote computers, such as a remote computer(s) **950**. The remote computer(s) **950** can be a workstation, a server computer, a router, a personal computer, portable computer, microprocessor-based entertainment appliance, a peer device or other common network node, and typically includes many or all of the elements described relative to the computer **902**, although, for purposes of brevity, only a memory/storage device **952** is illustrated. The logical connections depicted include wired/wireless connectivity to a local area network (LAN) **954** and/or larger networks, e.g., a wide area network (WAN) **956**. Such LAN and WAN networking environments are commonplace in offices and companies, and facilitate enterprise-wide computer networks, such as intranets, all of which can connect to a global communications network, e.g., the Internet.

[0080] When used in a LAN networking environment, the computer **902** can be connected to the local network **954** through a wired and/or wireless communication network interface or adapter **958**. The adapter **958** can facilitate wired or wireless communication to the LAN **954**, which can also include a wireless access point (AP) disposed thereon for communicating with the adapter **958** in a wireless mode.

[0081] When used in a WAN networking environment, the computer **902** can include a modem **960** or can be connected to a communications server on the WAN **956** via other means for establishing communications over the WAN **956**, such as by way of the Internet. The modem **960**, which can be internal or external and a wired or wireless device, can be connected to the system bus **908** via the input device interface **944**. In a networked environment, program modules depicted relative to the computer **902** or portions thereof, can be stored in the remote memory/storage device **952**. It will be appreciated that the network connections shown are example and other means of establishing a communications link between the computers can be used.

[0082] When used in either a LAN or WAN networking environment, the computer **902** can access cloud storage systems or other network-based storage systems in addition to, or in place of, external storage devices **916** as described above. Generally, a connection between the computer **902** and a cloud storage system can be established over a LAN **954** or WAN **956** e.g., by the adapter **958** or modem **960**, respectively. Upon connecting the computer **902** to an associated cloud storage system, the external storage interface **926** can, with the aid of the adapter **958** and/or

modem **960**, manage storage provided by the cloud storage system as it would other types of external storage. For instance, the external storage interface **926** can be configured to provide access to cloud storage sources as if those sources were physically connected to the computer **902**. [0083] The computer **902** can be operable to communicate with any wireless devices or entities operatively disposed in wireless communication, e.g., a printer, scanner, desktop and/or portable computer, portable data assistant, communications satellite, any piece of equipment or location associated with a wirelessly detectable tag (e.g., a kiosk, news stand, store shelf, etc.), and telephone. This can include Wireless Fidelity (Wi-Fi) and Bluetooth® wireless technologies. Thus, the communication can be a predefined structure as with a conventional network or simply an ad hoc communication between at least two devices.

[0084] As used in this application, the terms “component,” “system,” “platform,” “interface,” and the like, can refer to and/or can include a computer-related entity or an entity related to an operational machine with one or more specific functionalities. The entities disclosed herein can be either hardware, a combination of hardware and software, software, or software in execution. For example, a component can be, but is not limited to being, a process running on a processor, a processor, an object, an executable, a thread of execution, a program, and/or a computer. By way of illustration, both an application running on a server and the server can be a component. One or more components can reside within a process and/or thread of execution and a component can be localized on one computer and/or distributed between two or more computers. In another example, respective components can execute from various computer readable media having various data structures stored thereon. The components can communicate via local and/or remote processes such as in accordance with a signal having one or more data packets (e.g., data from one component interacting with another component in a local system, distributed system, and/or across a network such as the Internet with other systems via the signal). As another example, a component can be an apparatus with specific functionality provided by mechanical parts operated by electric or electronic circuitry, which is operated by a software or firmware application executed by a processor. In such a case, the processor can be internal or external to the apparatus and can execute at least a part of the software or firmware application. As yet another example, a component can be an apparatus that provides specific functionality through electronic components without mechanical parts, wherein the electronic components can include a processor or other means to execute software or firmware that confers at least in part the functionality of the electronic components. In an aspect, a component can emulate an electronic component via a virtual machine, e.g., within a cloud computing system.

[0085] In addition, the term “or” is intended to mean an inclusive “or” rather than an exclusive “or.” That is, unless specified otherwise, or clear from context, “X employs A or B” is intended to mean any of the natural inclusive permutations. That is, if X employs A; X employs B; or X employs both A and B, then “X employs A or B” is satisfied under any of the foregoing instances. Moreover, articles “a” and “an” as used in the subject specification and annexed drawings should generally be construed to mean “one or more” unless specified otherwise or clear from context to be directed to a singular form. As used herein, the terms “example” and/or “exemplary” are utilized to mean serving as an example, instance, or illustration and are intended to be non-limiting. For the avoidance of doubt, the subject matter disclosed herein is not limited by such examples. In addition, any aspect or design described herein as an “example” and/or “exemplary” is not necessarily to be construed as preferred or advantageous over other aspects or designs, nor is it meant to preclude equivalent exemplary structures and techniques known to those of ordinary skill in the art.

[0086] As it is employed in the subject specification, the term “processor” can refer to substantially any computing processing unit or device comprising, but not limited to, single-core processors; single-processors with software multithread execution capability; multi-core processors; multi-core processors with software multithread execution capability; multi-core processors with hardware

multithread technology; parallel platforms; and parallel platforms with distributed shared memory. Additionally, a processor can refer to an integrated circuit, an application specific integrated circuit (ASIC), a digital signal processor (DSP), a field programmable gate array (FPGA), a programmable logic controller (PLC), a complex programmable logic device (CPLD), a discrete gate or transistor logic, discrete hardware components, or any combination thereof designed to perform the functions described herein. Further, processors can exploit nano-scale architectures such as, but not limited to, molecular and quantum-dot based transistors, switches and gates, in order to optimize space usage or enhance performance of user equipment. A processor can also be implemented as a combination of computing processing units. In this disclosure, terms such as “store,” “storage,” “data store,” “data storage,” “database,” and substantially any other information storage component relevant to operation and functionality of a component are utilized to refer to “memory components,” entities embodied in a “memory,” or components comprising a memory. It is to be appreciated that memory and/or memory components described herein can be either volatile memory or nonvolatile memory or can include both volatile and nonvolatile memory. By way of illustration, and not limitation, nonvolatile memory can include read only memory (ROM), programmable ROM (PROM), electrically programmable ROM (EPROM), electrically erasable ROM (EEPROM), flash memory, or nonvolatile random-access memory (RAM) (e.g., ferroelectric RAM (FeRAM)). Volatile memory can include RAM, which can act as external cache memory, for example. By way of illustration and not limitation, RAM is available in many forms such as synchronous RAM (SRAM), dynamic RAM (DRAM), synchronous DRAM (SDRAM), double data rate SDRAM (DDR SDRAM), enhanced SDRAM (ESDRAM), Synchlink DRAM (SLDRAM), direct Rambus RAM (DRRAM), direct Rambus dynamic RAM (DRDRAM), and Rambus dynamic RAM (RDRAM). Additionally, the disclosed memory components of systems or computer-implemented methods herein are intended to include, without being limited to including, these and any other suitable types of memory.

[0087] What has been described above include mere examples of systems and computer-implemented methods. It is, of course, not possible to describe every conceivable combination of components or computer-implemented methods for purposes of describing this disclosure, but one of ordinary skill in the art can recognize that many further combinations and permutations of this disclosure are possible. Furthermore, to the extent that the terms “includes,” “has,” “possesses,” and the like are used in the detailed description, claims, appendices and drawings such terms are intended to be inclusive in a manner similar to the term “comprising” as “comprising” is interpreted when employed as a transitional word in a claim. The descriptions of the various embodiments have been presented for purposes of illustration but are not intended to be exhaustive or limited to the embodiments disclosed. Many modifications and variations will be apparent to those of ordinary skill in the art without departing from the scope and spirit of the described embodiments. The terminology used herein was chosen to best explain the principles of the embodiments, the practical application or technical improvement over technologies found in the marketplace, or to enable others of ordinary skill in the art to understand the embodiments disclosed herein.

Claims

1. A device, comprising: a processor; and a memory that stores executable instructions that, when executed by the processor, facilitate performance of operations, comprising: determining that a heating, ventilation, and air conditioning (HVAC) device, configured to provide a defined volume of air, is indicated to activate in response to an activation condition being satisfied with respect to a first zone of a group of zones; determining an excess volume of air representative of the defined volume of air provided by the HVAC device less a first zone volume that is delivered to the first zone; and performing an excess routing procedure that identifies a second zone of the group of

zones to which to route at least a portion of the excess volume, the excess routing procedure comprising: determining that the second zone, from among the group of zones, is most likely to trigger a subsequent activation condition for the HVAC device.
